

whatweretheythinking.com

www.pixelscapes.com/spatulacity/button.htm

Ever wondered during your net wanderings as to where it all stopped? Pixelscapes.com/spatulacity/button.htm could, very well, be the answer. The site features this humungous red-coloured button labelled 'Push'. And trust us, you will not need anymore. For you will not receive more.

At first, we tried to "push" the Really Big Button (RBB) and then tried to resist doing so. This is one button that actually does not take you anywhere. What the button does, we are destined to never know. Try clicking, it's completely futile. We can't blame the makers, for they've put up this warning: "The Really Big Button

That Doesn't Do Anything".

The Web site is fairly easy to navigate (it has to be! It's just one page after all). What really baked our noodle was how does a Web site, created in 1994, still have people flocking to it and actually paying homage?

In fact, several visitors have attempted to immortalise the RBB by hailing it as the new age peace mantra or written off about their

frustrated attempts. Read the postings and you'll know what we are talking about. And you can check the RBB guestbook and sign it if you'd like. Who knows, even you might be converted! Still, reviews we can comprehend. Poetry, we cannot.

"On a page far away

Stood the Really Big Button

An emblem of suffering and shame."

And all this for naught.



thus far, both internationally and here in India as well, it's a relief to hear that such scandals might soon not occur. Not that people will stop being amorous or stupid, but simply by providing the sender of information with the controls!

Staelium UK has developed StealthText, an SMS delivery system that allows the sender to send messages that will be deleted from the receiver's phone 40 seconds after it has been read.

The catch here is that both the sender and the receiver need to have WAP access and WAP-enabled phones. However, only the sender of such messages needs to download a StealthText applet.

When a StealthText SMS is sent, the receiver gets a notification type of message that displays the sender's name and a link to the actual message.

Now, if the receiver goes to that link, via WAP, the message is flagged as read and it simply cannot be

accessed from the server 40 seconds later. For people who are concerned about the legal and security aspects of this sort of system, the good news is that the e-paper trail will still exist, and can be made available to the authorities on demand.

Although the SMS is no longer viewable by the receiver after 40 seconds, it is archived on the server.

Staelium claims that this service will be a boon for celebrities who are afraid of being blackmailed later, or businessmen who urgently need to send confidential information to colleagues.

The company also plans to introduce the same technology for e-mail, voice, picture and MMS messages. Perhaps now we will be able to go for more than a few months without a new MMS scandal taking place—provided we get to see this technology, and people consciously use it! ■

Compiled by Jyotsna Rege,
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Blog WATCH

Berners-Lee, the man behind the Web has started to blog. Poke fun at the Star Parivaar awards. Read about some interesting keyboards, and how Christmas shopping is an unavoidable part of this jolly season. Blogwatch as varied as it can be

Leon Kilat-The Cybercafe Experiments
<http://max.limpag.com/>

Lee tries out blogging

(Via del.icio.us) The man who wove the World Wide Web, as Time puts it in a 1999 article, has started blogging to try publishing content using blog tools. Tim Berners-Lee said he never felt the "urge to blog with blogging tools" because he has largely been updating websites using Amaya and Nvu (an excellent open source WYSIWYG editor).

Lee said in his blog: "we have blogs and wikis, and the fact that they are so popular makes me feel I wasn't crazy to think people needed a creative space."

Ramanand
<http://quatrainman.blogspot.com/>

The JaDe Project - 7, Category: Awards

There are awards and there are self-thumping awards, but none like the *Star Parivaar* Awards. I mean, what the heck? Take a look at last year's award winners here, but more importantly, at the categories: A Best collection of *Pati, Patni, Naya Sadasya, Khalnayak, Devar/ani, Jethani, Yogya Bahu, Saas/Sasur*. All these are merrily laughable, but I draw the line at *Best Saut*.

These awards are supposed to be for the entire Star Plus channels, but by having Saut-ern categories, aren't they constraining the competition? A giant K-ego massage at best. We haven't even hit "Best JoDi"—I would have voted for Amitabh and Computer-ji.

Dave Roberts
<http://www.findinglisp.com/blog/>

More Interesting Keyboards

The other day I posted about Das Keyboard being an interesting twist on keyboards, being unlabeled. At Interop this week, I happened to run into a company called Zeomi, who makes a keyboard with an added tab key. Basically, they put a duplicate tab key under the arrow keys, over by the keypad. They say that if you do lots of data entry into either spreadsheets or forms where tab is used to move among fields, this can really speed things up, presumably because you can be flipping through papers with your left hand while your right hand does everything on the numeric keypad. I did find it humorous that they're trying to patent this.

Jon Choo
<http://jonchoo.blogspot.com/>

Christmas Shopping

I always hate it when shops lie—advertise something on offer to court you in, then trying to persuade you to get something else because there are none in stock! HMV has been doing it lately and yesterday I forced myself through Oxford Street (I hate that part of Central London) visiting two of their larger stores—and none had the package I wanted!

Eventually I had to get it at GAME. The situation is similar to UK's Xbox 360 pre-order debacle, create a hype but be unable to fulfil it.